

Your Financial Model — Plain-English Review & the Way Forward

An honest look at the Brightstar “Business Plan 2025” model, and how we make it real.

PREPARED FOR Coenie & Ilse Venter · 16 June 2026 · Private & Confidential

Coenie — you said the figures in the model are what the previous advisor put in, and **definitely not the real numbers**, otherwise the situation today would look different. You’re right. Here is the plain truth of it, and the smart way to fix it — **without you and Ilse ever having to hand your books to anyone.**

1 What you already have — the good news

The model itself is **professionally built** (by Brightstar) — and it’s much more than a revenue forecast. It’s a **complete model of the whole farm**, 10 years out: production and yield by grade, finished-goods stock and what it costs you per kg, debtors and creditors, your buildings and equipment, the loans and the interest, the full profit & loss, balance sheet, cash flow, VAT and tax — and whether you’re meeting the bank’s covenants. The **engine is sound and the history in it is real**. We’re not throwing any of that away — we’re going to **feed it the right fuel**.

Think of it as **your whole farm written in numbers** — what grows, what’s in stock, what it costs, what you own, what you owe, what you make, and what the taxman and the bank will say. That’s exactly why the real numbers matter so much: this one model drives *every* financial answer about the business.

2 Where it goes wrong — in one picture

The model’s *history* is real, but the *future* it then predicts was built on hopeful assumptions — not what your farm actually does. That is the gap you felt:

The farm’s story	Revenue	Profit reality
REAL · 2023 actual	≈ R3.8 million	Modest profit
REAL · 2024 actual	≈ R6.5 million	Roughly break-even after costs
ASSUMED · 2025 forecast	≈ R9.8 million	Profit appears
ASSUMED · 2026 forecast	≈ R25.6 million	Nearly 4x the best real year
ASSUMED · 2027–2034	flat ≈ R28 million	Held flat for 7 years

In plain terms: the model assumes the farm jumps from a **break-even R6.5 million** year straight to **R25.6 million at profit margins more than double anything ILCO has ever achieved** — and then simply holds that line for years. That is a hope, not a forecast.

3 Why this matters

A financial model is the tool a **bank, an investor, or your board** uses to make decisions. Built on guesses, it can quietly point you the wrong way and cost you credibility the moment someone checks it against reality. Built on **your real numbers**, it becomes a weapon — believable, defensible, and it shows the *true* path to growth instead of a fairy tale.

4 The smart fix — you stay in control of your numbers

You and Ilse **never hand your books to us or anyone else**. Instead, we give you a simple, private, step-by-step form where **you** enter your own real figures. And here is the clever part:

- 1 It pre-fills what we already know.** Your new farm system (going live this week) and the Origin till already capture production, harvest and sales — so those lines are filled in for you automatically.
- 2 You only add the confidential bits.** The private financial lines — your real costs, loans and accounts — you type in yourself, on your own screen. They stay yours.
- 3 It rebuilds the model instantly** on those real numbers, ready for the bank or the board.

Because the model covers the **whole farm**, most of it fills itself in from the system that's now running the farm and the shop. Here is the clean split — the operational side fills in by itself; only the private money side is yours to enter:

The system fills this in automatically	You enter privately (stays yours)
What's grown & harvested — yield by grade (A / B / Pops / Trim), clones	Your real selling prices & sales terms
What's in stock — finished-goods on hand, what it cost to make per kg	Real production & operating costs (labour, inputs, overheads)
What's sold — Origin till & online orders, money in	The loans — drawdowns, repayments, interest, the bank's terms
Who owes you / debtors & creditors as the orders flow	Shareholders & equity — capital in, dividends out
The assets on the ground — buildings & equipment in use	Anything confidential you'd rather not put in front of the team

From those two sides together the model builds the rest by itself — the **full profit & loss, balance sheet, cash flow, VAT and tax, and the bank-covenant checks**. That is the whole farm's operations and finances in one living picture, and you only ever touched the private money side.

The bonus — it stays alive. Because the farm system goes live this week (the site commissioning and the staff training on FM, Cultivation, Processing and QA), your real numbers start flowing in from day one. The model stops being a once-off snapshot that goes stale on a shelf — it becomes a **living picture that updates as the farm runs**.

5 Where it lives — right inside your dashboard

This isn't a spreadsheet sitting on someone's laptop. The model plugs straight into **your owner dashboard** — the same screen that shows you the farm and the shop:

- 1 The model and your dashboard read the same numbers.** What's grown, harvested and sold flows in from one place — so the forecast and the live business never disagree.
- 2 You see your forecast live** — revenue, profit, cash, and whether you're meeting the bank's terms — sitting right next to the rest of the business, not in a separate file.
- 3 It warns you when reality drifts off the plan** — so the forecast can never quietly go stale on a shelf the way the old one did.
- 4 One button for the bank or board** — it produces a clean, branded Excel/PDF from the same real numbers whenever you need it.

6 What we need from you to start

Only a few things, all entered **privately by you** — never shared with the team: your latest management accounts, your real monthly cost and loan figures, and a quick confirmation that this private, self-load approach is the way you'd like to go. We handle the rest.
